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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 3 : Session – 7 | Root Cause of Environmental Problems (Film-Based Session)

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. The ROOT CAUSE of environmental problems is not technology, population or industry per se — it is the human being's mistaken ASSUMPTION that 'physical facility is everything' and the resulting unlimited consumption, exploitation and domination of nature. When the Self assumes happiness comes from accumulating and consuming, every technology — however efficient — is used to extract more, faster. Hence environmental degradation is an outward symptom of an inner lack of right understanding (animal consciousness).
2. Q2. SYMPTOMATIC treatment addresses the visible problem while leaving the cause intact: e.g., treating polluted river water with purification plants while factories continue to dump effluents; or electric cars that shift pollution from tailpipe to mine. SAMADHAN (the all-encompassing solution) removes the cause itself: right understanding in the human being -> right utilisation of resources, cyclical production, restrained consumption — so pollution is not generated in the first place. Symptomatic relief is temporary and shifts the problem; samadhan is permanent.
3. Q3. The human being's ROLE in the FOUR ORDERS: toward the MATERIAL order — right utilisation (use only what is needed, ensure cyclicity); toward the PRANIC (plant) order — protection and enrichment (nurture soil, forests); toward the ANIMAL order — protection and care (not cruelty, not extinction); toward the HUMAN order — mutual fulfilment through right feeling. In all four, the human role is to be the PARTICIPANT who completes and enriches the harmony, since only the human has the freedom to understand or to violate it.
4. Q4. My OBSERVATION after the film: I noticed how my own daily acts — leaving taps running, wasting food, buying things I discard in weeks — are small versions of the same assumption that causes the big crises. My CONDUCT CHANGE: (1) I will buy only what I have assessed as a real need (right utilisation); (2) I will separate waste and compost/recycle so that my consumption participates in the cyclical process; (3) I will walk or use shared transport for short distances. These are small, but conduct change at the level of the Self is where samadhan begins.